

She argued that women should play an active role in religion. Dentièrè's is the only female name to appear on Geneva's Reformation Wall honoring the founders of Protestantism.

Despite such contributions, women were still marginalized from public roles in the Reformation. Luther and Calvin stated that a woman's place was to manage the household, and obey her husband and father. Women could not preach or act as ministers in most Protestant churches, although radical groups

such as the Anabaptists had female preachers. In supporting the closure of nunneries, the Reformation removed some of the power women had held, as their abolition destroyed one of the few spaces in which women could be educated and have a degree of independence.



BIOGRAPHY

JEANNE D'ALBRET

The kingdom of Navarre on the Franco-Spanish border was ruled by Jeanne D'Albret from 1555–1572. Raised a Catholic and educated by humanist scholars, Jeanne announced her conversion to Protestantism in 1560. During the French Wars of Religion in 1562 Jeanne tried to remain neutral. However, she became leader of the Protestants, and in 1570 negotiated a truce that briefly ended the conflict. Jeanne died in 1572; it took until 1598 for her son Henry to bring the Wars to a close.



◀ Nine-day queen

Lady Jane Grey was proclaimed queen in 1553 in an attempt to secure a Protestant succession in England. Nine days later, Mary I claimed the throne and Jane was executed, at the age of just 16.